

Chief Celeb Executive

IN 2019, WHEN Katrina Kaif started her entrepreneurial journey with Kay Beauty in partnership with Nykaa, little did she know that in about three years, the brand would surpass an annualised GMV of ₹100 crore. Kaif has ensured that the brand's expansion strategy is on point. It is now present in more than 100 general stores, 90-plus Nykaa outlets, and can be delivered to

1,600-plus cities. What sets her apart from other celebs is her hands-on approach; Kaif oversees crucial stages of the brand's development. "When we started this journey, making Kay Beauty accessible to everyone was a huge priority. This expansion in distribution will deepen engagement as more consumers see and feel the magic of our products," she says. **BT**



KATRINA KAIF

40, ACTOR & ENTREPRENEUR

— BY PRERNA LIDHOO

MEDIA MAGNATE

JYOTI DESHPANDE CALLS herself a leader who approaches business decisions devoid of personal biases. Part of *BT*'s Most Powerful Women in Business 2023 list, her strategic clarity shines in succinctly articulating problems, opportunities, and solutions.

Under her leadership, Jio Studios—Reliance's

content arm—marked a historic milestone in April 2023 with the launch of a 100+ asset slate, the largest in India's entertainment industry. This move solidified Jio Studios as a content market leader across genres, languages, and content types. "It was special to not only work with established top talent but equally with budding

writers, directors, actors, and technicians and give them a platform to shine," she says. "Scaling and 'Jiofication' of the fragmented boutique content industry were especially satisfying, as was the successful launch of Jio Cinema and IPL," she adds.

Deshpande advocates proactive efforts for women in leadership, encouraging conscious hiring and mentoring. She believes in "walking the talk" to promote diversity. "In my leadership team at Jio Studios, we have 70 per cent women leaders who are all at the top of their game," she says. For Jio Studios, this commitment is evident in championing stories like *Mimi*, *Baipan Bhaari Deva*, *Laapataa Ladies*. Deshpande's leadership stands as a beacon, not just for business acumen but for transformative inclusivity in the whole industry. **BT**

— BY PRERNA LIDHOO

WHAT KEEPS ME GOING

Having a strong sense of purpose that is tested and evolves from time to time

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JYOTI DESHPANDE

53, PRESIDENT, RIL MEDIA BUSINESS

HOUSE RULES

Masaba Gupta—fashion designer, actor and entrepreneur—has made it to *BT*'s Most Powerful Women in Business list once again after her debut last year. In 2023, Gupta worked towards scaling her businesses, apparel line House of Masaba and cosmetics label LoveChild, and also dabbled with investments in start-ups.



MASABA GUPTA

34, Founder, House of Masaba

Gupta sees Tier II and III cities as growth drivers. Incidentally, Aditya Birla Fashion and Retail acquired 51 per cent stake in House of Masaba in 2022. Gupta plans to set up an offline presence for her brands, starting with tie-ups with retailers like Reliance-owned Tira. "The Indian beauty market is not as evolved as it is globally, and so far, only a few colours sell," she says. **BT**

— BY AAKANKSHA CHATURVEDI